Murder at Loveland Harbor

The story so far: The year is 2026. The members of a niche internet forum for discussing the TV show "Black Sight" have decided to establish a sovereign island utopia. In October, the members of the online community arrive at the (fictional) island of Loveland Harbor, off the coast of (the real) Matinicus Isle, Maine.

Your host EvilGrungus, who inherited the land from their Grand-Aunt, has been making preparations for the island to be habitable, but things are thrown into disarray almost immediately. As it turns out, being in online sci-fi chatrooms rarely correlates with having practical survival skills, and everyone is cold, hungry and vindictive. On October 30th, gunshots are heard at 8:00pm, and the body of your host is shortly found near an old stone cottage built by previous attempted-settlers. At 9:00pm, your DiY radio picks up a message from the police that a murder has been reported at Loveland Harbor, and the authorities will be arriving by midnight to take everyone into custody for questioning. You've got 3 hours to find the culprit, cover your tracks, or make a general mess of things. Go.

This game is played over the course of 3 real world hours. On the "Username" sheet in this envelope, you'll see information about your character and what their general deal is, including a **Primary Objective** and **Secondary Objective**, which are unique to your character. These objectives have "points" attached to them, but don't worry too hard about that; it's to give you an idea of how important an objective is for your character (and maybe bragging rights).

Clues are the heart of the game, scattered far and wide across this apartment. They might be a direct piece of evidence, a part of a puzzle, or require additional Clues to make sense of it. Feel free to show Clues to other players if you wish, or to trade them.

You will have to move real-world stuff to access Clues, so I ask you to be careful and put things back after you've moved them. If you've got questions on how/if it's okay to touch something, just ask!

Aside from finding Clues in the apartment, your main method of evidence-gathering will be **Extracting a Confession** from other players: when you give someone two of your Clues, you may ask them any question, and they must give you one of their **Testimony** slips (info about their character, everyone has a booklet of them) that best answers the question. This question might be as vague as "what's the most

incriminating detail about you?", or hyper-specific like "is my character listed in the 'Relationships' section of your username sheet?". If they don't have any information close to answering your question, they can choose any one Testimony slip to give you.

The player receiving your two Clues chooses one to keep and one to discard in the Evidence Locker (on the kitchen table). You can choose to trade Testimony slips freely, if you wish. The blank slips in your booklet are for if you run out of your pre-printed ones.

End of game: At the end of the 3 hours, I'll call everyone together to present your final cases, and each person will have around 5 minutes to make their case. These are ultimately quite social objectives, so don't stress if you haven't found a perfectly logical trail of evidence. Arguments, hunches and general vibes are expected and encouraged (though you should still seek out real evidence, as every mystery has a findable solution). When you present, you'll be using your **Dossier** (your labelled envelope on the kitchen table), which you'll have filled throughout the game with the evidence you need to complete your Primary Objective. What's in your Dossier is safe from the meddling of other players, but once you've sealed the envelope, making any future changes requires you to donate a Clue to the Evidence Locker or Public Information (also boxes on the kitchen table).

Consumables: certain Clues are marked as Consumable, and provide a one-use game effect (such as looking at or taking Clues/Testimony). A Consumable that has been ripped in half (indicating it has been used) no longer functions as a Clue for any purpose. Feel free to put these spent Consumables in the Public Information pile, or even the real trash can, as they no longer serve a purpose.

Final Note. I've spelled out everything in as many places as possible: If something says you can't show it to others then you can't show it to others, but everything else is fair game. If something says not to touch it then don't touch it, otherwise go crazy. When in doubt ask, but I'm not trying to confuse you. I really hope you enjoy Murder at Loveland Harbor!

P.S. Content notes - this is a pretty PG game; there's murder of course, and some alcohol/drug/tobacco mentions, and I think there's swearing in a Clue or two. But the intent has been for a fun and lighthearted murder-mystery romp, and not like, Immensely Tragic and Traumatizing. Ok thanks have fun <3

P.P.S. There are some references to real people/places/media, but most things are fictitious. Hopefully that's obvious, and I don't think mistaking a fictitious thing for a real one will affect anything, but I suppose now you've been warned.